

WRITE PROMPTS THAT GET USEFUL WORK DONE

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A STRONG PROMPT REMOVES GUESSWORK

THE FIVE SIGNALS

Give the model a frame

Give the model a role, a situation, a clear task, boundaries, and a defined output.

Match structure to stakes

The more consequential the work, the more valuable the structure.

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START WITH THE ROLE YOU NEED

PERSPECTIVE BEFORE OUTPUT

Assign relevant expertise: senior software engineer, content strategist, financial analyst.

Specify the skill or field so the response begins from the right perspective.



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CONTEXT TURNS A TASK INTO A REAL PROBLEM

WHAT CHANGES THE ANSWER

Explain what you are working on and what you are trying to achieve.

Include the audience, stage, inputs, and decisions that shape the work.

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MAKE THE TASK EXPLICIT AND SEQUENTIAL

A TASK SHOULD HAVE A FINISH LINE

01

State the outcome you want.

02

Break complex work into steps.

03

Define what “done” should contain.

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CONSTRAINTS PROTECT QUALITY

> Set tone, format, length, level of detail, and what to avoid.

LESS NOISE · MORE RELEVANCE

Quality has boundaries

Constraints reduce irrelevant, speculative, or overly technical answers.

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SPECIFY THE SHAPE OF THE ANSWER

DESIGN THE READER’S PATH

Reader’s path

Choose the reader’s path: executive summary, analysis, recommendations, next steps.

Working format

Ask for bullets, a table, Markdown, or another format when it matters.

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USE THE FRAMEWORK AS A REUSABLE SCAFFOLD

FIVE PARTS · ONE REPEATABLE BRIEF

01 **Role**

who should think?

02 **Context**

what situation matters?

03 **Task**

what should happen?

04 **Constraints**

what boundaries apply?

05 **Output**

what should the answer look like?

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EXAMPLE: FROM VAGUE REQUEST TO USEFUL BRIEF

PROMPT TRANSFORMATION



Vague: “Analyze our launch plan.”

Structured: assign a strategist, explain the launch, request a risk analysis, set a concise executive tone, and require summary, findings, and next steps.



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MAKE EVERY PROMPT EASIER TO ACT ON

A PRACTICAL CHECK BEFORE YOU SEND

1. Lead with the outcome.
2. Add only context that changes the answer.
3. State the constraints explicitly.
4. Request a format you can use immediately.

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THANK YOU

Questions and feedback are welcome.

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